



Community Engagement Project: Federally Qualified Health Centers & Preventative Healthcare

AGENDA

- Background
- Purpose and Objectives
- Data results
- What this means
- Survey results
- Our community impact

BACKGROUND



FQHC: Federally Qualified Health Centers. These are community-based health care providers that receive federal funds to provide primary care services in underserved areas.



Sliding fee scale: Cost of medical services vary based on patients' income



Preventative care: Focus on disease prevention, includes screenings and tests to **detect &** prevent diseases or catch them in early stages

PURPOSE AND OBJECTIVES



Purpose: Despite the presence of FQHCs in Georgia, equipped to assist underserved/ underinsured residents, preventive care services remain underutilized. As a result, those facing higher risks for chronic conditions are **less** likely to access preventive care when they are available and low-cost.

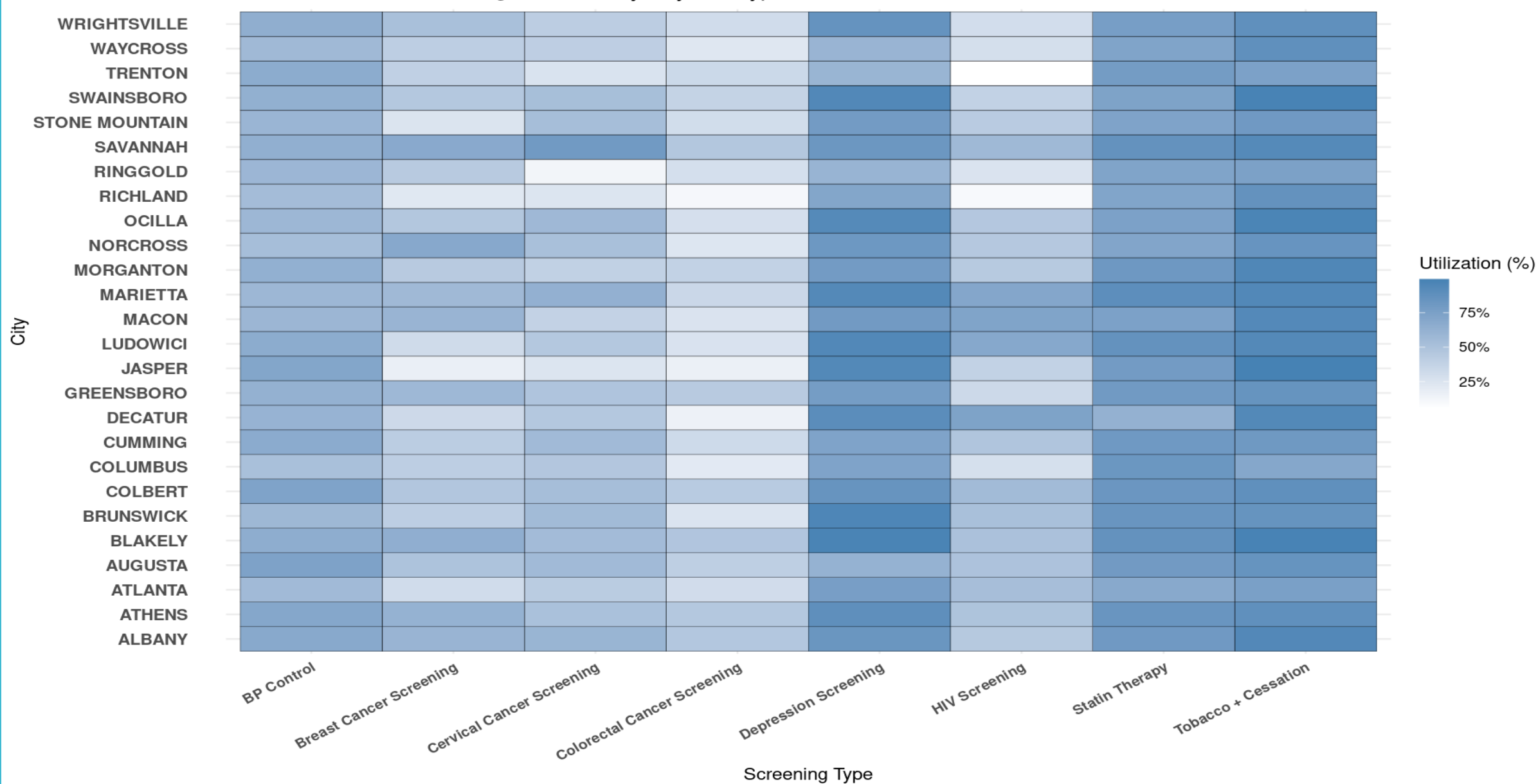


Objective 1: Understand why people in underserved communities are not utilizing FQHCs for preventive care and how can we bridge that gap to improve health outcomes?

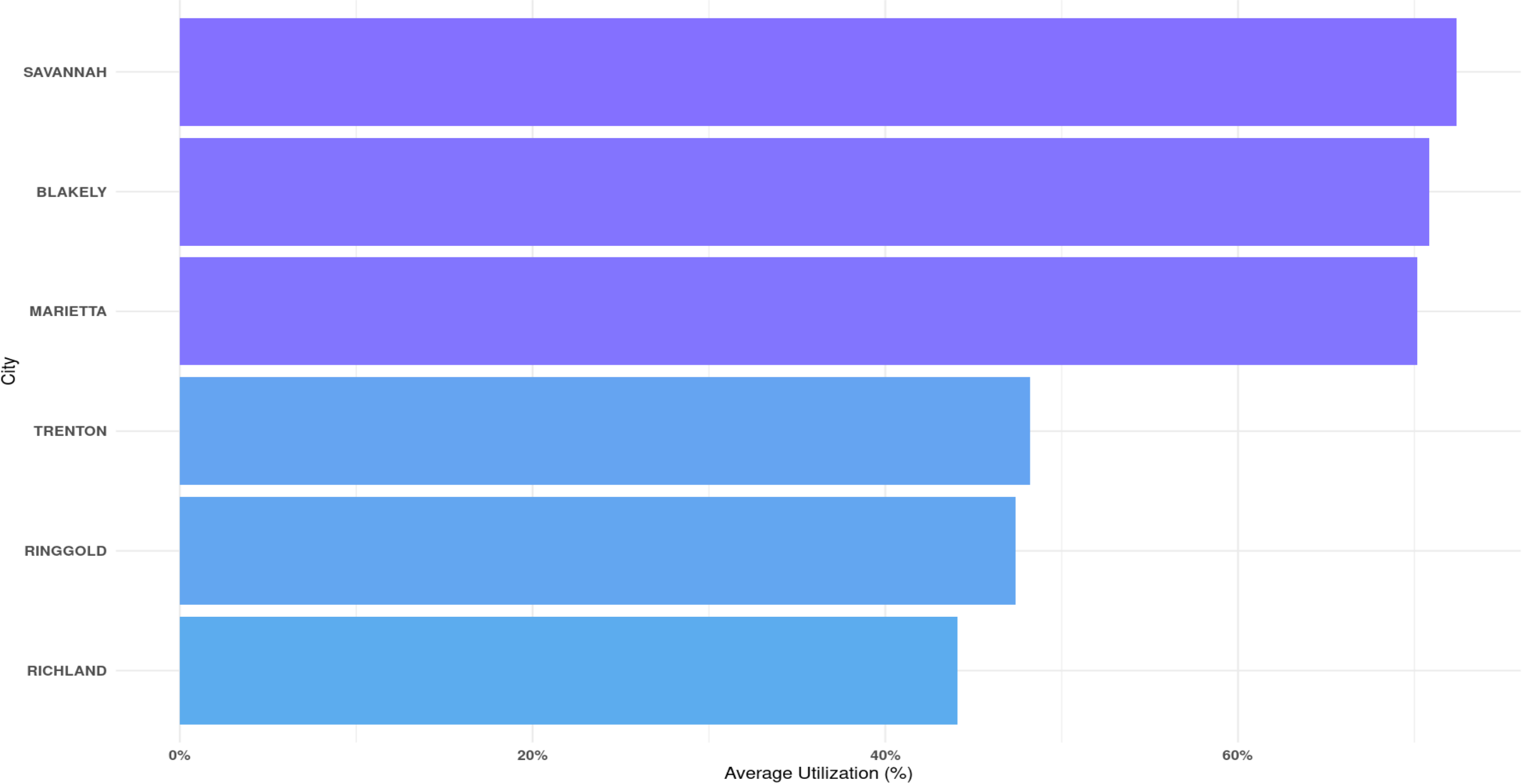


Objective 2: Produce a reasonable potential solution for the most promanate issue regarding accessing FQHCs based on qualitative analysis and the community's insight

Mean Preventive Screening Utilization by City and Type



Average Preventive Screening Utilization: Top & Bottom 3 Cities



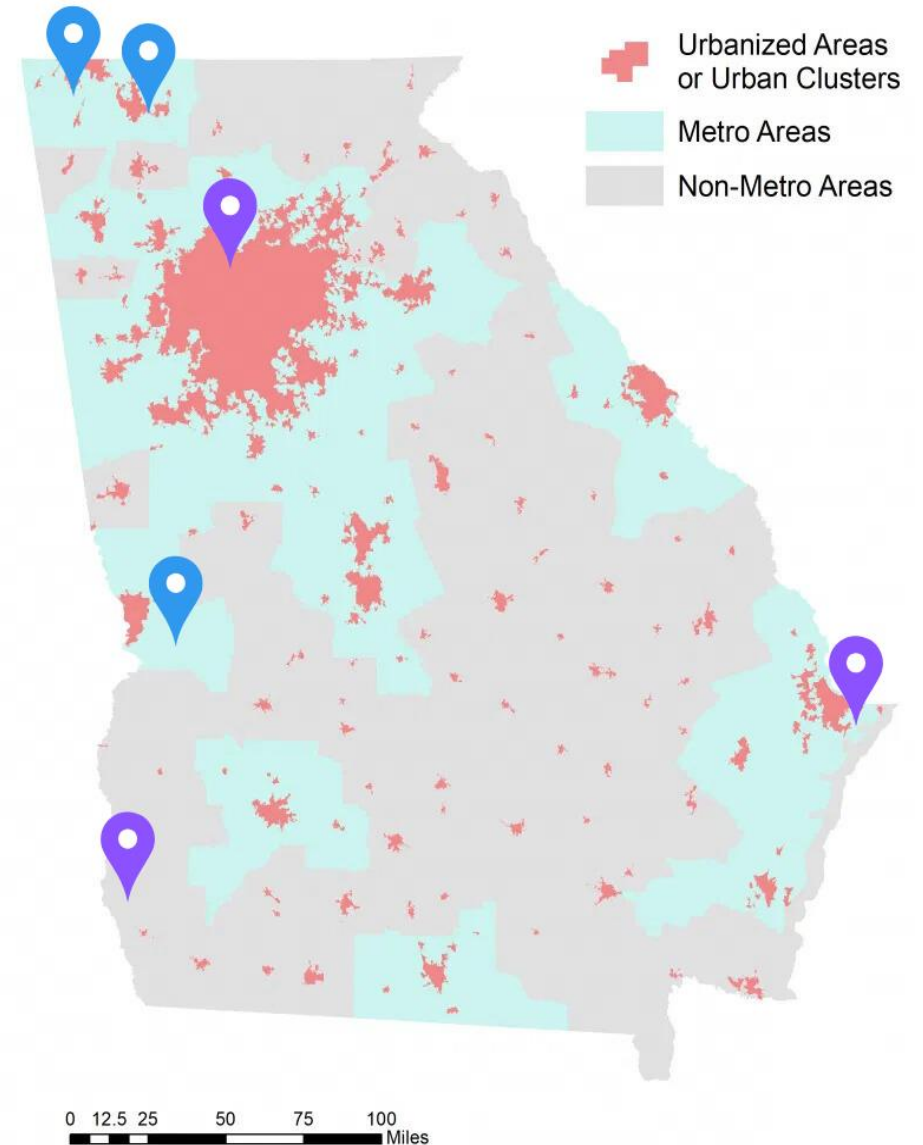
CONTEXTUALIZING THE GRAPH

Purple Points represent the cities with the highest utilization and the blue point represent the lowest utilization.

The cities with the highest utilization tend to be in urbanized areas with metro access, aside from Blakely

The cities with the lowest utilization tend to still be in areas with metro access and in areas with mild urbanization

What does this tell us? To understand the *why* behind these trends, we turn to the voices of Georgia residents.



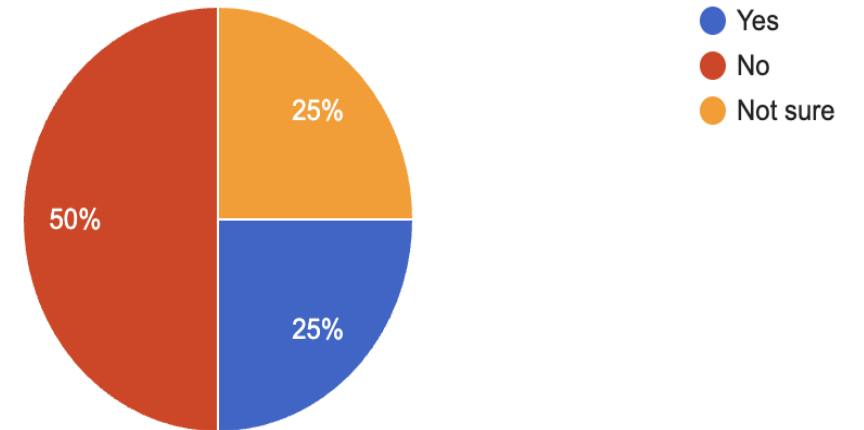
SURVEY RESULTS

To help us understand how individuals access primary healthcare we conducted a community-based survey focused on awareness, usage, and perceived barriers.

Have you ever heard of Federally Qualified Health Centers (FQHCs)?

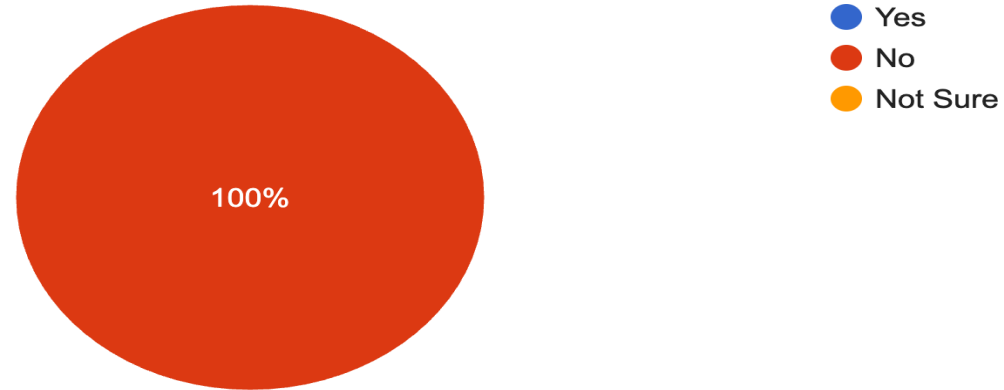
(FQHCs are health centers that provide affordable healthcare for those with limited financial resources regardless of their insurance status.)

8 responses



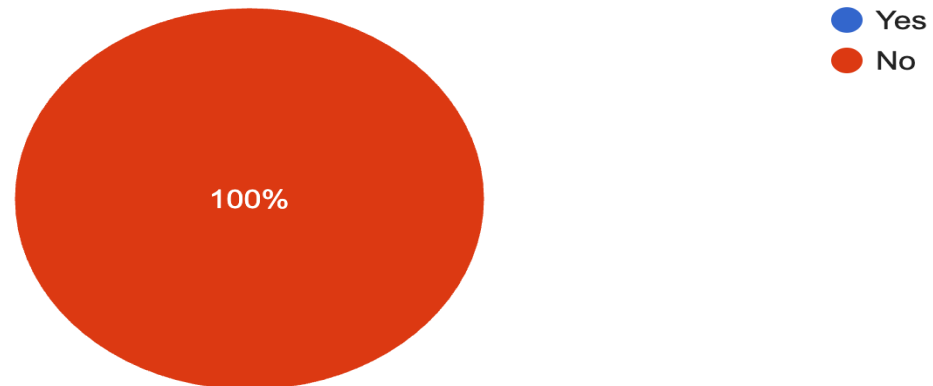
Do you know where the nearest FQHC is located to your current residence?

8 responses



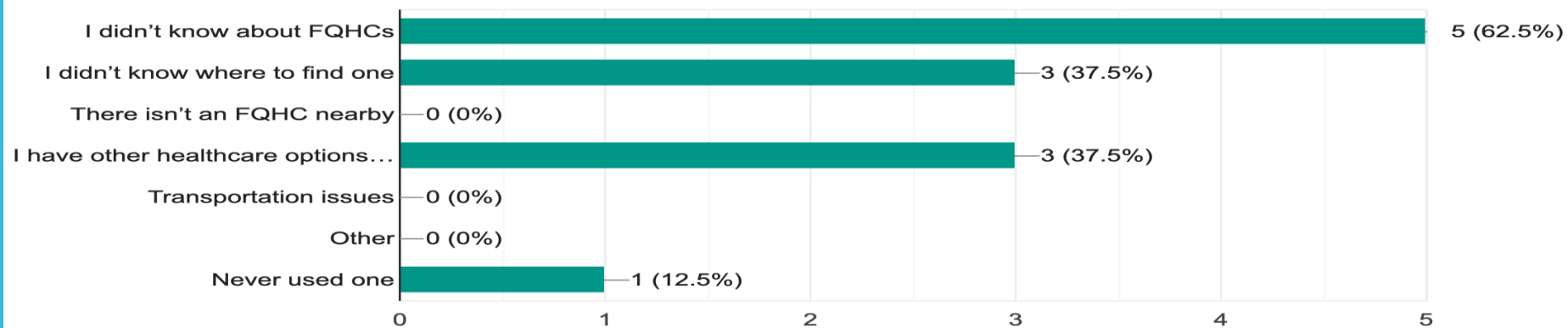
Have you ever used an FQHC for healthcare services?

8 responses



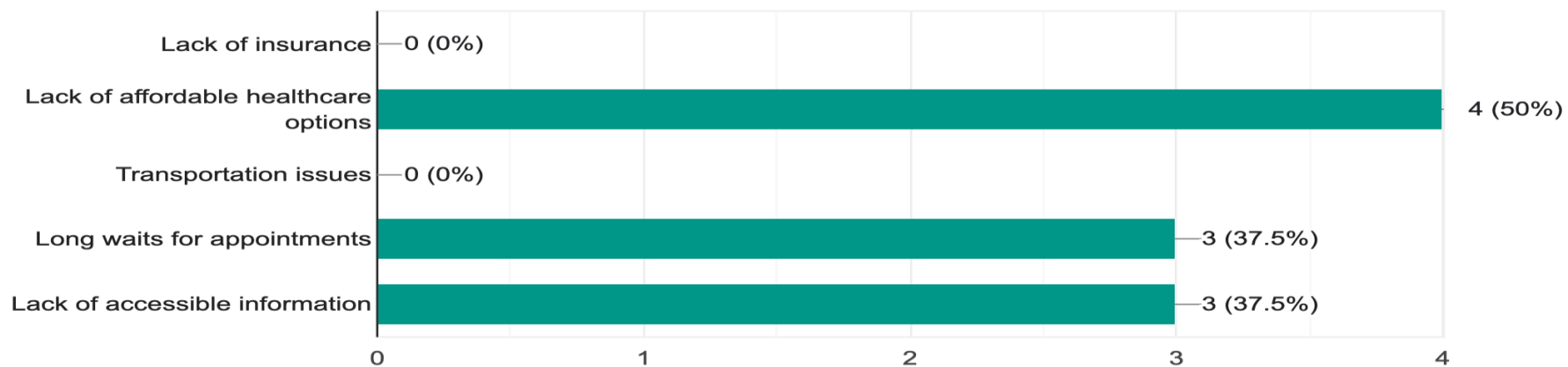
If you have NOT used an FQHC, please select the reason(s) that apply:

8 responses



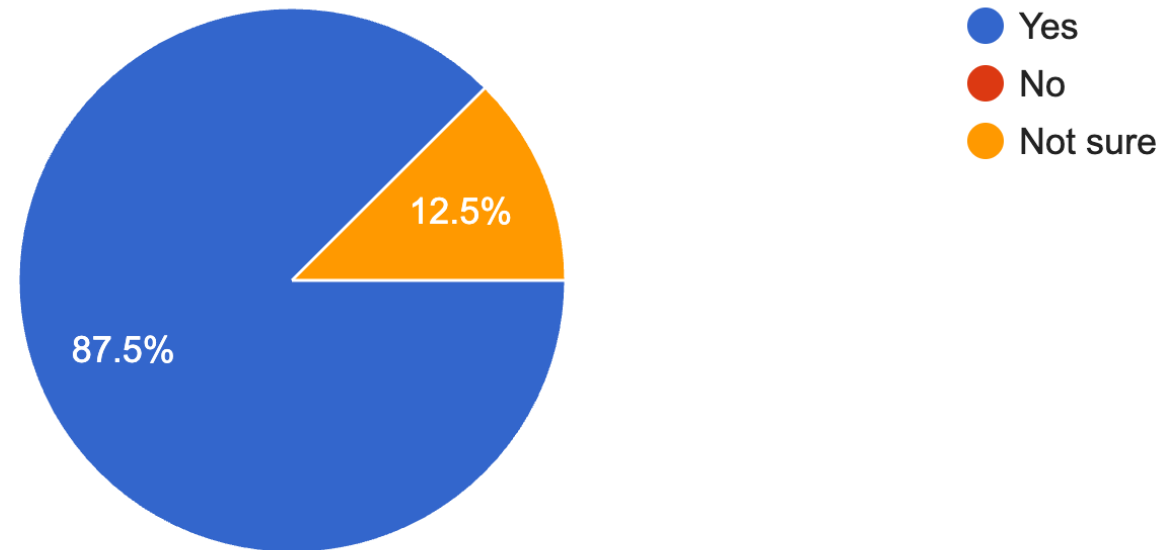
What barriers do you face when trying to access healthcare?

8 responses



Would you be more likely to seek primary or preventive healthcare if you knew the cost would be based on your income, making it more affordable compared to typical healthcare costs?

8 responses



WHAT DO THESE RESULTS TELL US?

Lots of People don't know about FQHCs and the services they offer

Most people have never used an FQHC that they are aware of

Most agreed that they would prefer to be charged on a sliding scale

Most people don't know where the closest FQHC is located

Lack of affordability, long wait times and limited information make it difficult to access healthcare

List of FQHCs in Georgia



<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1PIloV5Bn1cjO4XEZrwhfmCqTamtjKI2U/view>

Solution to Address Some of These Issues

LIMITATIONS

Adding more
Questions to
our Survey

Survey
residents in our
top 3 and
lowest 3 cities

HRSA dataset from
2023 and as we have
previously discussed,
a lot can change in 2
years

More survey
responses can give
us a better insight

Potential
Sampling Bias

References

<https://data.hrsa.gov/tools/data-reporting/program-data/?type=AWARDEE&state=GA>

<https://data.hrsa.gov/data/download>

<https://data.hrsa.gov/data/reports/datagrid?gridName=FQHCs>

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<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1PIloV5Bn1cjO4XEZrwhfmCqTamtjKI2U/view>



THANKYOU
FOR
LISTENING!